

Wells Fargo Interview Experience

About the Company:

Wells Fargo is one of the largest financial services companies in the United States, headquartered in San Francisco. It provides banking, investment, mortgage, and consumer and commercial finance services. With operations in more than 30 countries, Wells Fargo serves millions of customers worldwide.

It is also among the top 4 banks in the U.S., alongside JPMorgan Chase, Bank of America, and Citigroup.

Selection Process:

The selection process consisted of four rounds in total.

1. Online Assessment
2. Technical Round
3. Techno-behavioural round
4. HR Round

1. Online Assessment:

The assessment had four sections.

Section 1:

There was only one DSA question to solve. This section had different sets. We were given 1 hour to solve this. We were asked to type the code from scratch. The problem statement was as follows, we are given an array of 10 numbers. Each index value (1-indexed) represents kilometers, and the value at that index represents the fare for traveling that particular distance.

For example, if we have an array:

prices = [12, 34, 56, 32, 90, 34, 78, 45, 33, 89]

- The cost for traveling 1 km is 12
- The cost for traveling 2 km is 34
- ...and so on.

The total distance to be covered is given as input. Our task is to find the **minimum cost** to travel that distance among all possible combinations. A key point is that the same ticket can be purchased multiple times. For example, you can travel 10 km twice to cover 20 km.

I initially used recursion with dynamic programming (DP) to solve this, but my solution didn't work correctly because it failed to handle multiple ticket purchases (reusing the same ticket more than once). Another important note: only **Java** was allowed for this section.

Example Test Case

prices = [12, 34, 56, 32, 90, 34, 78, 45, 33, 89]

totalDistance = 20

Possible Combinations:

- 10 km + 10 km = 89 + 89 = 178
- 5 km + 5 km + 10 km = 90 + 90 + 89 = 269 (worse)
- 2 km × 10 times = 34 × 10 = 340 (worse)
- 1 km × 20 times = 12 × 20 = 240 (still worse)
- 8 km + 6 km + 6 km = 45 + 34 + 34 = **113 (best so far)**

So, the minimum cost = 113.

Section 2:

The second section consisted of English aptitude questions. These included:

- Reading comprehension
- Questions on tenses
- Filling in the correct sentence or word for the underlined portion

A basic understanding of English grammar and comprehension was sufficient to perform well in this section.

Section 3:

The third section consisted of business aptitude questions. These included analyzing bar charts and graphs, interpreting candlestick charts, and applying some basic knowledge of stocks and shares. There were also scenario-based questions, such as suggesting the most suitable investment in a given situation. A basic understanding of stocks, shares, and simple mathematics was sufficient to solve this section. Overall, it primarily tested our analytical skills.

Section 4:

The fourth section was coding once again. The questions were relatively easy, with two problems in total. This section also had different sets, meaning different candidates received different set of questions. In my set, one of the questions was to remove vowels from a given string. The other was to find the kth smallest element in an array, with both the array and the value of k provided as input.

2. Technical Interview:

This interview was conducted virtually through a video call, and it went for 1 hour and 15 minutes. The interviewer began by asking me to introduce myself and then moved on to discuss my project. He focused on the technical aspects, pointed out some logical flaws, and asked me to suggest ways to improve and handle those issues.

After this discussion, he gave me a SQL query problem and asked me to share my screen, open Notepad, and type the solution. The question was: *find the second highest salary in each department of an employee table*. I initially solved it using LIMIT and OFFSET, but he was not satisfied. He expected a solution using the RANK() function in SQL.

Next, he asked me to open a compiler and implement a sorting algorithm. I first attempted merge sort, but my code didn't work as expected. I then switched to quick sort, which worked correctly. After that, he asked me to perform a binary search on the sorted array. I implemented the code, and he tested it with multiple edge cases to ensure it worked for all scenarios.

Finally, he wrapped up the interview by asking if I had any questions for him. Always prepare a set of questions to ask the interviewer so that they know that you care about the company. Since I had prepared beforehand, I asked a thoughtful question to show my interest. The interview concluded positively, and I was selected for the third round.

3. Techno-Behavioural round:

This was a short session, lasting about 15 minutes, and it was conducted in person. The interviewer began by asking me to introduce myself. He then asked which subject I was most interested in, and I mentioned DBMS. It's important to highlight the subject in which you are technically strong.

He proceeded with DBMS-related questions, such as:

- What is a table?
- How do you store data?
- What is the use of databases?

- How do you uniquely identify a row in a table?
- How do you establish relationships between tables?
- What is referential integrity?

After this, he shifted to Java since I had mentioned being comfortable with it. I explained that I primarily use Java for solving DSA problems. He asked about the data structures available in Java and how I use them.

Finally, he gave me the opportunity to ask questions. After I did, the round concluded. I was selected for the fourth and final round. Along with technical knowledge, he was also assessing my communication skills throughout the session.

4.HR Round:

This round was casual and felt more like a conversation. It was conducted in person. The interviewer began by asking me to introduce myself. She then asked about my project, and I explained it in detail.

Next, she asked why I would be the best fit for the company. I highlighted both my technical expertise and soft skills, explaining how they aligned with the company's values and requirements. She also asked me to explain the difference between an AI-based project and a regular project like a web application, but in a way that even a layperson could understand.

Afterward, she provided me with some tips for improving my communication and shared insights about the work culture at Wells Fargo. Toward the end, I asked her a few questions, to which she responded thoroughly.

Fortunately, I was selected, along with nine other candidates, for the intern role.

Tips:

- Practice and solve DSA questions regularly on platforms like LeetCode, HackerRank, and GeeksforGeeks.
- Be thorough with core concepts such as DBMS, OOPs, DSA, Operating Systems, and Computer Networks.
- Keep your resume clean, simple, and well-structured.
- Know your resume inside out, as most of the questions will be based on it.
- Always answer clearly and concisely.

Wishing everyone the best in their preparation. I'll be happy to connect on LinkedIn for any guidance

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